



HALO INFINITE

THE CHIEF IS BACK WITH A VENGEANCE!

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Before we get into this review for Halo Infinite, I should let you know that I haven't exactly been following the Halo franchise. The only Halo game I'd played prior to Halo Infinite was the very first Halo Combat Evolved, which was a damn good game. Understandably, I'm skipping a considerable amount of lore and backstory here by jumping straight to Halo Infinite. With that being said, I actually had a really good time playing Halo Infinite, and while I definitely felt a bit of a disconnect at times from the game's main story, it was an enjoyable ride.

GAMEPLAY

We'll get to the story in a bit, but I cannot stress enough how incredibly fun Halo Infinite's gameplay loop is. It's not just a

single thing that stands out, but rather how everything works together. This is the first Halo game to embrace the open-world format, and the execution in Halo Infinite is excellent. 343 Industries has done an excellent job of taking the linear(ish) environments, that Halo was originally known for, and blowing it up to a grander scale. They've managed to do this without making things feel cumbersome. There's a healthy sprinkling of things to do on the map as you make your way towards the next objective. These include recapturing Forward Operating Bases (FOBs), rescuing marine squads, infiltrating Banished fortresses and priority targets, which are like boss challenges. I should mention that the game's not "truly" open-world. Parts of the world won't open up till you complete the relevant story mission.

Before you even set foot on the open-world, however, you will spend the early hours of the game learning the ropes, or firing it out of your wrist rather. We're talking of course, about the Grappleshot. Like everything else in Halo Infinite we've mentioned so far, a grappling hook is nothing new. You should already be familiar with it if you've played games like Just Cause and Titanfall. But again, like everything else, it just feels right in Halo Infinite. You can use the grappleshot to grab weapons or fusion coils from a distance, get out of a pinch batman style when your shields are depleted, or literally launch yourself at enemies and whack them in the face with a stronger-than-usual melee attack. The grappleshot is the first of the equipment you will unlock in Halo Infinite, and the one you will probably use the most. It makes tra-